



OPEN ME FIRST

CoWork OS

Your local agentic operating system for work and life

Build your own AI agent ecosystem. No code required.

Set Up in 5 Minutes

Four steps to go from zip file to a working AI system. Do these in order before anything else.

1

Move the zip file

Move the CoWork OS zip to your Documents folder (or wherever you keep important folders). This is where Claude will live, so pick somewhere stable.

2

Unzip it

Double-click the zip to extract it. You'll see a **CoWork OS** folder with subfolders: ABOUT ME, WORK AREAS, RESOURCES, and KNOWLEDGE. Don't rename or rearrange anything.

3

Open Claude and select the folder

Open the Claude desktop app and **select the CoWork tab** in the sidebar — that's where the file system access lives, not in regular chat or Claude Code. Start a **new session**. Under the main chat window you'll see a drop-down that says **"Work in a project"** — open it, find your **CoWork OS** folder, and select it. Click the **star icon** to favourite it so Claude always works from this folder. If you don't have Claude yet: **claude.ai/download** (Pro account minimum). For the best onboarding results, select **Claude Opus** as your model — it's the most capable and will set up your files with more depth. Note: setup may use a good chunk of your daily credits, so start fresh.

4

Paste this prompt

This is the magic line that sets up the whole system. Paste it into the **CoWork tab** in the Claude desktop app — the same window where you just selected the folder in Step 3.

```
Please begin CoWork OS setup. Read ABOUT ME/first-run.md and follow it exactly — present all four skill cards for me to save one at a time, then run the Onboarding Coach through every step in order without skipping any.
```

That's it. Claude takes over from here — about 20 minutes through the 11 setup steps. Everything is conversational.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

The onboarding will ask about you, your work, and how you communicate. A few ways to make that easier:

Use dictation

Voice input is the fastest way to tell Claude about yourself. Just talk naturally and it types for you. Don't have a dictation tool? **Download Wispr Flow free** — it works brilliantly with Claude.

Paste existing context

If you've been using ChatGPT or Gemini, ask it to export everything it knows about you. Paste that into the onboarding chat to get a head start.

Attach documents

Got an existing bio, brand guide, or writing samples? Drag them into the chat. Claude can pull the relevant details directly from your files.

Just type

No prep needed. The onboarding coach asks clear questions with clickable options. You can always come back and add more detail later.

Your Folder Map

This folder is a ready-made system that turns Claude CoWork into a personalised AI operating system. Here's what each piece does.

CLAUDE.md

Global instructions that tell Claude how to behave

ABOUT ME/

Six files that teach Claude who you are

about-me.md · voice-profile.md · writing-rules.md
my-context-map.md · specialist-routing.md · memory.md

RESOURCES/

MY SKILLS/ — Four included skills: Onboarding Coach, System Review, First Week Guide, Knowledge Base Health Check

PLUGINS/ — Your agent ecosystem. Install plugins from the Better Creating marketplace (see Plugins Installation Guide)

TEMPLATES/ — Patterns for projects, emails, decisions, and more

GUIDES/ — Prompting Cookbook, CASA Framework, Good Practices, Sub-Agent Builder, Plugins Installation, Knowledge Base Guide (PDF + slides for each)

WORK AREAS/

Organised by domain: Admin-PA, Business, Finance, Marketing, Personal (one subfolder per project)

KNOWLEDGE/

Your local second brain. One or more knowledge bases, each with verbatim RAW sources, a Claude-maintained Wiki, and Outputs for queries.

See RESOURCES/GUIDES/Knowledge-Base-Guide.pdf and the walkthrough video at youtu.be/ib74sLgjlBM.

The CLAUDE.md file is already in this folder. When you select it as your CoWork workspace, Claude reads it automatically. For best practice, also paste it into your global instructions in CoWork settings (gear icon).

Install Your Skills

When you first open this folder in CoWork, Claude will show you four skills to install — one click each. Each one switches on a different capability of your system.

Onboarding Coach

Walks you through setting up your About Me files interactively. Say "set up my system" to start. ~20 minutes.

System Review

Your self-improving feedback loop. Reads memory, spots patterns, proposes updates. Say "review my system" anytime.

First Week Guide

Five days of guided tasks that produce real output. Say "first week guide" to start.

Knowledge Base Health Check

Audits your KNOWLEDGE/ folder, auto-fixes routine drift, drafts new wiki articles. Runs monthly on its own.

After installing, say 'set up my system' to launch the Onboarding Coach. It teaches as it goes — you'll finish with a personalised system that knows your voice, your tools, and how you work.

If the cards don't appear, ask Claude to "present the four skills in RESOURCES/MY SKILLS/ for me to install" — that triggers the install flow manually. Or install them by hand from **Customise → Personal Skills → + and selecting each .skill file from the folder.**

Quick Primer

Download the Claude desktop app from claude.ai/download. Sign in, **select the CoWork tab** in the sidebar (not regular chat or Claude Code — that's where the file system access lives), then select this folder as your workspace. CoWork can only see files inside this folder — it can't access your whole computer.

I'd recommend the **Pro account** to start. Once you're running scheduled tasks, a **Max account** is probably the best money you'll spend. Think of it as a very cheap employee, not expensive software.

WHAT MAKES THIS DIFFERENT

Your Agent Ecosystem

CoWork OS isn't just a folder structure. It's an agentic operating system — a platform for building, installing, and managing your own AI specialist agents.

Built-in Skills

Pre-installed in RESOURCES/MY SKILLS/. Includes the Onboarding Coach, System Review, First Week Guide, and Knowledge Base Health Check — plus CoWork's built-in doc and spreadsheet tools. Build your own custom skills too.

Marketplace Plugins

Ready-made specialists from the Better Creating marketplace. Set up the marketplace once, then install any plugin with one click. See the Plugins Installation Guide in RESOURCES/GUIDES/.

Custom Agents

Build your own specialists with the included Sub-Agent Builder — each one an expert powered by a knowledge base you seed. See the Builder Guide in RESOURCES/GUIDES/ for details.

Skills are tools. Plugins are specialists who bring their own tools and deep domain expertise. Your About Me files are the identity layer that makes everything personal.

THE FLAGSHIP FEATURE

It Improves Itself

System Review

The System Review skill reads your memory files, spots patterns in how you work, and proposes improvements to your About Me files, writing rules, and system configuration. Run it on demand ('review my system') or as a monthly scheduled task. Every recommendation comes with exact text you approve or reject — one click to make it better.

This is what makes CoWork OS a living system, not a static template. The longer you use it, the better it gets.

Your Tools, Working Together

CoWork connects to your existing tools through connectors (plug icon in settings). Each takes about 30 seconds. CoWork creates drafts — it never sends without your permission.

Gmail

Reads your inbox, summarises messages, drafts replies in your voice. Combined with Calendar: "Draft a reply to Sarah suggesting Thursday — check my calendar for a free slot."

Google Calendar

See your schedule, find free time, create events. Powers morning briefings and meeting prep.

Notion

Searches your databases, creates pages, references your knowledge base. When connected, Claude sees your plans, projects, notes, and context.

Google Drive

Search files, read documents, reference your existing work. "Find the proposal I wrote for Acme last month and use the same structure."

Slack

Read channels and threads, draft messages, search conversations. "Summarise what happened in #product this week."

Claude in Chrome

Browse the web, fill forms, interact with web apps. Extends CoWork's reach beyond your local files.

Each connector makes the others more capable. Gmail + Calendar = smart scheduling. Notion + Drive = full context. Start with the ones you use daily.

THE BEST FEATURE

Scheduled Tasks

CoWork can run tasks automatically on a timer, using everything you've configured. Set up a morning inbox triage — sorted by priority, with draft replies in your voice. What used to take 30–40 minutes takes five.

It drafts, it doesn't send. *You're always the final check. And because of your writing rules, the drafts sound like you — not like AI. Scheduled tasks need the Claude app running in the background — if it's not open, they'll run next time it is. Your system also checks at the start of each session whether a review is overdue, so nothing falls through the cracks.*

The Better Creating Plugin Marketplace

CoWork OS plugins live in a dedicated marketplace built by Better Creating. Add the marketplace once, and every plugin is available with one click.

Two plugins ship with CoWork OS today:

Personal Assistant — the instruction set that powers your Admin PA workspace. Turns your catch-all folder into a conversational second brain that references your About Me, memory, and project files.

Specialist Sub-Agent Builder — create dedicated specialist AI agents with their own knowledge base. The CoWork OS equivalent of Agent OS in Notion. No code required.

Read the **Plugins Installation Guide** in RESOURCES/GUIDES/ for setup steps, or just ask Claude: *"Help me install the CoWork OS plugins by connecting to Better Creating's Marketplace."*

GROUND RULES

How to Work with Your AI System

CoWork OS is powerful, but you're always in charge. These five rules keep things safe and productive.

- 1 Always review before sending.** Nothing gets sent, posted, or published without your explicit approval.
- 2 Your data stays in your folder.** CoWork can only see files inside your workspace folder unless you specifically grant access.
- 3 Don't share sensitive credentials.** Never paste passwords or API keys into your files. Use the official connectors for authentication.
- 4 Review scheduled task outputs.** Check automated outputs regularly, especially when first setting them up.
- 5 Keep your system honest.** The System Review proposes changes — but you approve every one. You're always the final word.

Your First Two Months

CoWork OS is a living system, not a static template. Here's the trajectory most people follow — and what to expect at each stage. Knowing the arc upfront makes the slow days make sense.

FIRST WEEK

Prove it works

The Onboarding Coach personalises your About Me files in about 20 minutes. Then the First Week Guide takes you through five days of real tasks — testing your voice, connecting your tools, drafting your first scheduled task, and reviewing what Claude has learned. By Friday you have five real outputs and a system that already feels like yours.

FIRST MONTH

It learns your patterns

Memory builds in the background as you work. The Personal Assistant captures decisions in your captain's log. Claude starts referencing what you've done before — "you decided X two weeks ago, want to apply the same pattern here?" The friction of explaining yourself drops. You stop pre-loading context every session because the system already knows.

SECOND MONTH AND BEYOND

It starts proposing improvements

The monthly System Review surfaces patterns you haven't named yet — duplicate work areas, missing rules, repeated frustrations, recurring projects worth turning into templates. The feedback loop kicks in. Plugins get suggested. You'll notice the system getting sharper without you steering it. This is the part that makes CoWork OS different from a system prompt or a memory tool: it improves itself.

If something isn't clicking by week two, say "review my system" — the System Review skill will read what you've actually done and propose the next step. The system is designed to course-correct itself.

What to Do Next

Your system is set up. Here's the path from setup to a system that genuinely works for you.

1

Install skills and run the Onboarding Coach

When you first open this folder, install the four skills with one click. Then say "set up my system" to personalise your About Me files. ~20 minutes.

2

Start the First Week Guide

Say "first week guide." Five days of real tasks — test your voice, connect your tools, make Claude think harder, build your first scheduled task, and review what it learned. Each day produces output you keep.

3

Set up a monthly System Review

The Onboarding Coach offers this at the end of setup. It runs automatically and proposes improvements to your system. This is what makes CoWork OS get better over time.

4

Explore Your Guides

Your RESOURCES/GUIDES/ folder has everything: the Prompting Cookbook, the Good Practices Guide, the CASA Framework, the Sub-Agent Builder Guide, the Plugins Installation Guide, and the Knowledge Base Guide.

CoWork OS is built on the CASA framework — Consolidate, Architect, Systematise, Activate. The CASA Framework Guide in your RESOURCES/GUIDES/ folder explains the full method and how CoWork OS fits alongside the Notion Business OS and Agent OS.

Systems Made Better

CoWork OS is part of the Better Creating ecosystem — tools, templates, and training for non-technical people building with AI.

Visit **bettercreating.com** for the Agentic Business Accelerator, free skills, system updates, and more. Join the email list — that's where new resources get shared first. Check your junk folder.

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